

controls that offer flexibility and protection, supporting most use cases with different user permissions and capabilities. And they have easy-to-use flexible user interfaces for quick extensibility and customisation.

WordPress, being the most adored platform, has the most plugins, and the largest developer community and market share. However, the popularity and openness of this platform, coupled with its simplicity, attracts hackers to exploit the weakness or poor security of the websites that use it. Although security is a big challenge and concern, staying ahead of the curve by understanding known vulnerabilities and addressing them with appropriate processes does help to keep hackers at bay.

It is critical to install the most up-to-date software version for the core platform along with all the plugins, extensions, and modules. The same applies to WordPress. Over 50 per cent of all sites hosted on WordPress that are hacked are on 'outdated' versions. It proves the point that just adopting a technology and framework is not enough; a process must be set up to ensure the platform is always up-to-date.

A common misconception is that developer self-service refers to a certain life cycle stage of a service or resource, namely, its start. People think they should focus on making it easy to clone templates or spin up a database without having to deal with Terraform. This is a part of the self-service. But I would argue it is a small part. Ask yourself this: How often do you spin up a new service or database? Not very often in the grand scheme of things. The real return on investment of self-service lies in the remaining parts of the service, app, or resource life cycle. This includes making it simple for a new developer to understand what belongs where, enabling clear and separated

Ease of ..	WordPress	Joomla	Drupal
Use (Market Share)	65%	15%	10%
Add text content	✓	✓	✓
Add media content	✓		
Maintenance	✓	✓	✓
Visual templates	✓	✓	
Security		✓	
Software Updates	Frequent	Frequent	Less Frequent
Plugins/Extensions	55K+	10K+	40K+

Figure 1: A comparison of the ease of use of popular open source CMS platforms

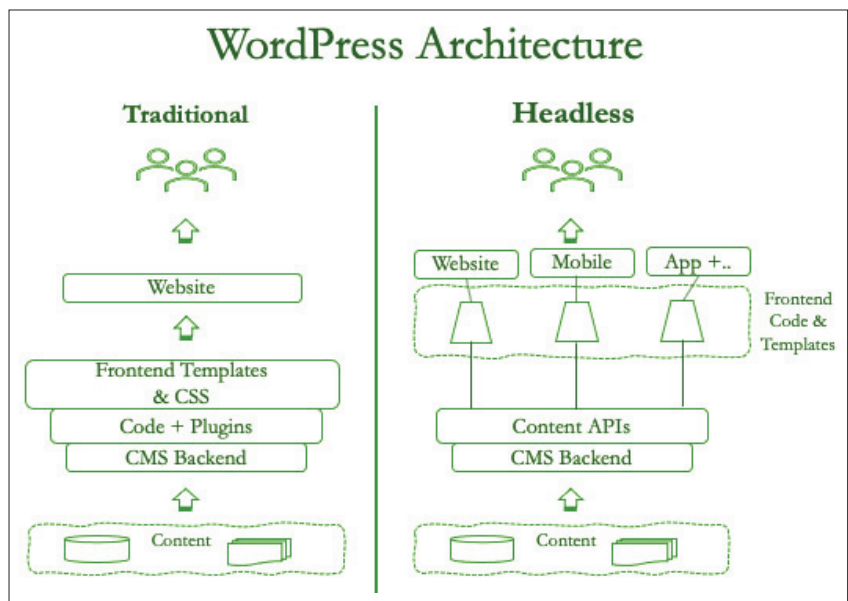


Figure 2: WordPress architecture for traditional and headless implementations

progression between environments, updating *env* variables effectively, updating resource configurations easily, ensuring security without taking freedom away; and making it super easy to debug deployments and surface error messages as well as consolidate logs. All this gets better through self-service!

The security of any application is as good as its weakest access point. It's important to know the architecture of the application, especially the deployment model, to ensure the infrastructure, network, and application access points are protected. WordPress architecture has two primary models — the